DueDuo

The DueDuo planning pack *for two*

Five printables to work through together. Start with the who-owns-what sheet: it takes 20 minutes, and it's the fastest way to make sure one person isn't carrying everything.

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dueduo.com · The week-by-week pregnancy planner for couples.

DueDuo is a planning tool, not medical advice. Your doctor or midwife knows your pregnancy best. Each guide's sources are listed on its page at dueduo.com/guides.

Who owns what: our pregnancy jobs

One owner per job, from noticing to done.

JOB	OWNER Tick one: Me, Partner, Together	DONE BY WEEK	DONE
Prenatal appointments and the shared calendar	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together	Ongoing	☐
Baby budget and both leave policies	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together	Weeks 9 to 10	☐
Childcare research and waitlists	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together	Weeks 14 to 16	☐
Parental leave paperwork	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together	Weeks 20 to 22	☐
Choosing a pediatrician	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together	Weeks 23 to 25	☐
After-birth plan: nights, chores, visitors	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together	Weeks 26 to 27	☐
Meal train	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together	Weeks 31 to 33	☐
Hospital bags	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together	Weeks 34 to 35	☐
Car seat installed and checked	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together	By week 36	☐
Telling family and work	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together	When you're ready	☐
	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together		☐
	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together		☐
	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together		☐
	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together		☐
	☐ Me ☐ Partner ☐ Together		☐

Our weekly check-in day: _____ · dueduo.com

Hospital bag checklist for two

The birthing parent's bag

- [ ] Photo ID, insurance card and hospital papers (in the UK, your maternity notes)
- [ ] Birth plan (2 copies)
- [ ] Phone and a long charging cable
- [ ] Comfortable robe and slippers
- [ ] 1 or 2 loose nightgowns or big T-shirts for labor
- [ ] Front-opening tops for skin-to-skin and feeding
- [ ] Nursing bras and breast pads
- [ ] Maternity pads and high-waist underwear
- [ ] Toiletries, lip balm, hair ties
- [ ] Any medicines you take, in their original packaging
- [ ] Glasses or contact lens case
- [ ] Loose going-home outfit

The partner's bag

- [ ] Snacks and a water bottle for both of you
- [ ] Change of clothes, spare underwear and a toothbrush, in case you stay overnight
- [ ] Phone charger or power bank
- [ ] Pillow and blanket
- [ ] Card or cash for parking and vending machines
- [ ] The hospital's address and phone number, and the route there
- [ ] Who to text once the baby arrives, and who tells whom
- [ ] A spare copy of the birth plan

The baby's bag

- [ ] Car seat, rear-facing and installed in the car before the due date. Hospital staff usually can't install it for you.
- [ ] 2 or 3 bodysuits and sleepsuits
- [ ] Hat, socks and mittens
- [ ] Swaddle or receiving blanket
- [ ] Newborn diapers (nappies), plus wipes or cotton wool and water
- [ ] Going-home outfit, with a warm layer if it's cold
- [ ] Formula and bottles, only if you plan to bottle-feed. Ask whether your hospital provides them.

Leave at home

- Jewelry and other valuables.
- Piles of baby clothes. Two or three changes are enough for a short stay.
- Towels and blankets for you. Many hospitals provide them, so check.
- Tampons. Use maternity pads after the birth.

Your hospital or birth center may have its own list. Ask at your next appointment.

Questions to ask at your prenatal appointments

First trimester

1. Which prenatal vitamin and dose is right for me?
2. Are all my current medications and supplements safe?
3. Which screening tests do you recommend, and when?
4. Which symptoms mean I should call you right away?
5. Can I keep doing my current exercise routine?

Second trimester

1. What will the anatomy scan check?
2. When is the glucose test, and do I need to fast?
3. Which vaccines do you recommend during pregnancy, and when?
4. Is it safe to travel, and until which week?
5. How will I know if the baby's movements are normal?

Third trimester

1. When exactly should we call or come in once labor starts?
2. What pain relief options are available where I'm giving birth?
3. What happens if I go past my due date?
4. When will you test for Group B strep?
5. Can we go over my birth preferences together?

For the partner to ask

1. If something worries us at night or on a weekend, who do we call?
2. Can I be there for the scans and the birth, and are there limits on visitors?
3. What should I know about getting to the hospital: parking, which entrance, what to bring?
4. What can I do to help during labor?
5. Which signs of depression or anxiety after the birth should we watch for, in either of us?

The partner's pregnancy to-do list

Weeks 0 to 6

- [ ] Book the first prenatal appointment. First visits usually happen around weeks 8 to 10, and slots fill up.
- [ ] If you have health insurance, check what it covers for prenatal care, scans, the birth and the newborn.

Weeks 7 to 8

- [ ] Take over the strong-smell chores: cooking, bins and the fridge. If you have a cat, take over the litter box too, because cat litter can carry toxoplasmosis, which is risky in pregnancy.
- [ ] Book time off to join the first visit, and put every appointment in a shared calendar.

Weeks 11 to 13

- [ ] Ask family and friends not to post the news before you announce it.

Weeks 14 to 16

- [ ] Research childcare and join waitlists. In some areas they're many months long. Note what each option costs.

Weeks 17 to 19

- [ ] Book the anatomy scan, usually at 18 to 22 weeks.
- [ ] Book antenatal and baby-care classes. Popular classes fill fast, and most people take them between weeks 28 and 36.

Weeks 20 to 22

- [ ] Request your parental leave. Tell your employer and agree dates now, so it isn't a last-minute scramble.
- [ ] Ask friends with older babies for hand-me-downs before buying anything.
- [ ] Price the big items: stroller, car seat and crib. Decide what to buy new and what second-hand.

Weeks 23 to 25

- [ ] Choose a pediatrician or family doctor for the baby. Check they're taking new patients.
- [ ] If a glucose test is offered, book it (usually at 24 to 28 weeks) and ask whether fasting is needed.

Weeks 28 to 30

- [ ] Add the more frequent appointments to the shared calendar. Visits often move to every 2 weeks or so now.

Weeks 31 to 33

- [ ] Pre-register at the hospital or birth center, and do the tour if you haven't.
- [ ] Buy and install the car seat. Follow the manual exactly, and have it checked by a certified technician if you can.
- [ ] Wash baby clothes and bedding in a fragrance-free detergent.
- [ ] Set up a meal train so friends and family can drop off food in the first weeks.

Weeks 34 to 35

- [ ] Plan the route to the hospital and a backup. Know where to park and which entrance to use at night.
- [ ] Tell family your hospital visitor plan before anyone makes travel plans.
- [ ] Arrange care for pets or other children, with a backup person available at any hour.

Week 36

- [ ] Set up a recovery station by the bed: maternity pads, a peri bottle, comfy underwear, nipple cream, snacks and water.
- [ ] Save key numbers in both phones: the labor ward, your doctor or midwife, the pediatrician, lactation support and a backup driver.

Weeks 37 to 39

- [ ] Ask family to wait for your news, with no calls during labor.
- [ ] Send your home visiting rules.
- [ ] Find the deadline for adding the baby to your health insurance. In the US, many plans give you about 30 days after the birth.
- [ ] Do a final check of the bags and the car seat.

Do these together

- Weeks 9 to 10: set up your baby budget, and read both parental leave policies for notice deadlines and pay.
- Weeks 26 to 27: agree who does what after the birth: night feeds, leave dates, chores, pets and visitors. Write it down and review it at week 36.
- Weeks 28 to 30: draft your birth preferences.
- Weeks 34 to 35: pack the hospital bags.
- Weeks 37 to 39: ask your doctor or midwife exactly when to call or come in, and write it down.

Baby things you can skip

What you do need

Before the birth

- [ ] Infant car seat (new, or second-hand only with its full history)
- [ ] Crib (cot) or bassinet (Moses basket) with a firm, flat mattress
- [ ] Fitted sheets x3
- [ ] Sleep sacks (baby sleeping bags) or swaddles x3
- [ ] Bodysuits (vests) and sleepsuits in 0 to 3 months (second-hand is fine)
- [ ] Diapers (nappies) and wipes for the first month
- [ ] Feeding basics
- [ ] Stroller (pushchair) or carrier (second-hand is fine)
- [ ] Thermometer, nail clippers and saline drops
- [ ] Postpartum recovery supplies for the birthing parent

Nice to have, after the baby shower or the first few weeks

- [ ] Baby monitor
- [ ] Bouncer (borrow one if you can)
- [ ] Changing pad on a dresser you already have
- [ ] Nursing pillow